

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



ASSOCIATION OF SOUTH-EAST ASIAN NATIONS
(ASEAN) - 1

MODULE -59

- 1 ASEAN stands for the Association of South-East Asian Nations. The member nations include Indonesia, Singapore, Philippines, Malaysia, Brunei, Thailand, Laos PDR, Myanmar, Vietnam.
- 2 ASEAN is a regional grouping working towards securing peace, progress and security.
- 3 ASEAN came into existence on August 8, 1967 after ASEAN declaration (also known as Bangkok declaration).
- 4 It is a regional organisation that aims to promote intergovernmental cooperation and facilitates economic integration amongst its members.
- 5 The Secretariat of ASEAN is at Jakarta, Indonesia. ASEAN is an official United Nations observer, as well as an active global partner.





VISION OF ASEAN

Its Motto is “One Vision, One Identity, One Community”. Its objectives for formation are:

- Socio-economic and cultural growth
- Encourage regional peace and stability
- Promote mutual collaboration and assistance
- Facilitate training and research
- Growth of agriculture and industry.



INDIA

Myanmar
(Burma)

Vietnam

Lao PDR

Thailand

Cambodia

Gulf of
Thailand

South China Sea

Philippines

Philippine Sea

Brunei

Malaysia

Indonesia

ASEAN COUNTRIES

Coral

INDIA AND ASEAN

- 1 The relationship between India and ASEAN members is growing stronger. India being inducted as a member of the ASEAN Regional Forum is an example of it.
- 2 The Act East policy of India consolidated the relationship between India and ASEAN.
- 3 Initially, it was limited to only trade and investment.
- 4 Now it has other dimensions like counter insurgency, cyber and maritime security, connectivity, etc. which have been included.



PARTNERSHIP BETWEEN ASEAN AND INDIA

- 1 Both India and ASEAN believe that maritime cooperation and centrality of trade are essential for the prosperity of Indo-Pacific.
- 2 Increased maritime connectivity would lower logistics cost and motivate trade in goods and services.
- 3 They became full Dialogue partners in 1994. India focuses on a strengthened and multi-faceted relationship with ASEAN.
- 4 India and ASEAN have a politico-security cooperation in the backdrop of the growing traditional and non-traditional security situation.
- 5 Maintaining cordiality with ASEAN as an organisation and with individual Southeast Asian countries is crucial.





North
Pacific
Ocean

There are several areas of cooperation between India and ASEAN.
These are:

- Political Security Cooperation
- Naval cooperation with ASEAN
- Economic Cooperation
- Socio-cultural cooperation

AREAS OF COOPERATION

POLITICAL SECURITY COOPERATION

- 1 With the growth of traditional and non-traditional challenges, India and ASEAN seek to coordinate, cooperate and share experiences at multiple levels.
- 2 India places ASEAN at the center of its Indo-Pacific vision of Security and Growth for All in the Region.
- 3 The main forum for ASEAN security dialogue is the ASEAN Regional Forum (ARF) India has been attending annual meetings of this forum since 1996 and has actively participated in various activities.
- 4 The ASEAN Defence Ministers' Meeting (ADMM) is the highest defence consultative and cooperative mechanism in ASEAN.



AREAS OF COOPERATION

POLITICAL SECURITY COOPERATION

- 5 The ADMM-Plus is a platform for ASEAN and its eight Dialogue Partners to strengthen security and defence cooperation for peace, stability, and development in the region.
- 6 The main objective of ADMM Plus is to benefit ASEAN member countries in building capacity to address shared security challenges.
- 7 The ADMM-Plus countries include ten ASEAN Member States and eight Plus countries, namely Australia, China, India, Japan, New Zealand, Republic of Korea, Russian Federation, and the United States.



AREAS OF COOPERATION

POLITICAL SECURITY COOPERATION

The principles for membership to the ADMM-Plus process a country shall be-

- 1 A full-fledged Dialogue Partner of ASEAN.
- 2 Have significant interactions and relations with ASEAN defence establishment
- 3 Able to work with the ADMM to build capacity to enhance regional security in a substantive way in order to promote capacity-building in the region in the fields of defence and security



AREAS OF COOPERATION

ECONOMIC COOPERATION

- 1 India-ASEAN trade and investment relations have been growing steadily, with ASEAN being the fourth largest trading partner.
- 2 India's trade with ASEAN stands at \$81.33 billion. The ASEAN-India Free Trade Area has been completed with the entering into force of the ASEAN India Agreements on Trade in Services and Investments on 1 July 2015.
- 3 The ASEAN-India Business Council (ABIC) was set up in March 2003 as a forum to bring key private sector players from India to ASEAN.
- 4 The Federation of ASEAN Travel Association (FATA) was formed for ASEAN countries to waive entry requirement for its member countries.



AREAS OF COOPERATION

NAVAL COOPERATION WITH ASEAN

- 1 The Navies of India and Indonesia will hold their first bilateral exercise in the Java Sea.
- 2 India will stage a new trilateral exercise with Thailand and Singapore.
- 3 India is instituting a series of bilateral and multilateral naval exercises with Association of South East Asian Nations (ASEAN) countries. This is being done as part of the increasing military-to-military cooperation.
- 4 India is also looking at a new multilateral exercise with ASEAN



AREAS OF COOPERATION

ECONOMIC COOPERATION

- 5 ASEAN has emerged as the second largest trade partner of India in 2017-18 with bilateral trade valued at USD 81.33 billion, comprising 10.58% of India's total trade with the world.
- 6 The ASEAN-India Business Council (AIBC) presented their recommendations to the forum to sustain the momentum of trade and investment in the region.
- 7 Issues related to promoting connectivity, collaboration on Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) development, blue economy, healthcare, and tourism as well as women and youth economic empowerment are matters of concern.



AREAS OF COOPERATION

SOCIO-CULTURAL COOPERATION

1 India is organising large number of programs to boost People-to-People interaction with ASEAN, such as inviting students to India each year for the Students Exchange Program.

2 India is also cooperating with ASEAN through projects like Exchange of Farmers, ASEAN-India Fellowships for Higher Education in India and ASEAN, Exchange of Agriculture Scientists, Empowerment of Women through Cooperative, etc.



AREAS OF COOPERATION

- 1 ASEAN India connectivity is a priority for India as also the ASEAN countries.
- 2 In 2013, India became the third dialogue partner of ASEAN to initiate the ASEAN Connectivity Coordination Committee India Meeting.
- 3 There has been progress in implementing the India-Myanmar Trilateral Highway and the Kaladan Multimodal Project.



ASEAN-INDIA CONNECTIVITY SUMMIT (AICS)

- 1 India hosted the ASEAN-India Connectivity Summit (AICS) on the theme “Powering Digital and Physical Linkages for Asia in the 21st Century”.
- 2 It was organised by the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) in collaboration with AIC (ASEAN-India Centre) and CII (Confederation of Indian Industry).
- 3 It was organised as part of the celebratory events being organised to commemorate the silver jubilee of ASEAN-India dialogue partnership



ASEAN-INDIA CONNECTIVITY SUMMIT (AICS)

- 4 The AICS aims to accelerate existing connectivity prospects, identify issues of concern, evolve suitable policy recommendations and develop strategies to enhance economic, industrial and trade relations between ASEAN and India.
- 5 Its focus areas are infrastructure, roadways, shipping, digital, finance, energy and aviation.
- 6 Participants were policy-makers, senior officials from the government, investors, industry leaders, representatives of trade associations and entrepreneurs on the same platform.



ASEAN-INDIA COMMEMORATIVE SUMMIT

- 1 **Delhi declaration** was adopted at the ASEAN-India Commemorative Summit.
- 2 ASEAN-India Commemorative Summit was held to **celebrate the 25th anniversary of the establishment of sectoral dialogue** between two sides under the theme of “**Shared Values, Common Destiny**”.
- 3 India and 10 ASEAN countries for the first time mentioned **cross-border movement of terrorists** and made commitment to counter the challenge through close cooperation as part of the declaration.
- 4 The 9th edition of the Delhi Dialogue was held in New Delhi. The Delhi Dialogue is an **annual event to discuss politico-security, economic and socio-cultural engagement** between ASEAN and India.



ASEAN-INDIA COMMEMORATIVE SUMMIT

- 5 It has been held annually since 2009. The theme for Delhi Dialogue 9 is “ASEAN-India Relations: Charting the Course for the Next 25 Years”.
- 6 Delhi Dialogue is a conference in which policymakers converge to discuss a range of issues relating to India-ASEAN relations.
- 7 The Delhi Dialogue is being organised by the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) in collaboration with the Observer Research Foundation (ORF), Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI), and other bodies of the ASEAN countries.



INCREASING COOPERATION

- 1 The bilateral with Indonesia is in addition to the Coordinated Patrol (CORPAT) that the two sides conduct.
- 2 The bilateral with Indonesia will be held after the conclusion of the Malabar trilateral naval war games between India, Japan and the U.S. which is underway off the coast of Guam.
- 3 Two of the ships participating in Malabar will head to the Rim of the Pacific Exercise (RIMPAC), the world's largest multilateral exercise, hosted by the U.S. biennially off the Hawaii islands.
- 4 India's ASEAN policy compliments its SAGARMALA project; as the latter recognises the central role played by the seas and oceans around India and the ASEAN region, in promoting stable economic progress and providing a stable and secure environment.



ECONOMIC SUPPORT FOR PROJECTS

The funding for the different socio-economic and political projects are as follows:

- 1 ASEAN India Cooperative Fund** - India announced a contribution of \$50 million to the ASEAN-India Fund for capacity building program in the political, economic and sociocultural spheres for deepening and intensifying ASEAN-India Cooperation.
- 2 ASEAN-India S7T Development Fund (AISTDF)**- In 2007, India announced setting up of this fund with \$1 million contribution from India to promote joint collaborative R&D research projects in Science & Technology.
- 3 ASEAN-India Green Fund**- In 2007, India announced the setting up this fund with an initial contribution of \$5 million fund from India, to support collaborative activities relating to environment and climate change.



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